



Toilet paper thieves

Chinese authorities are fighting them using facial recognition softwares on dispensors.
<http://dgit.in/FaceToilet>



ARM's DynamIQ chip

The next generation mobile chip design puts focus on AI.
<http://dgit.in/DynamIQ>

CAREERS IN ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

It's the hottest tech in town and everyone wants a bite. With ingredients like data, data and more data, are you ready to serve AI on a platter?



Arnab Mukherjee
arnab@digit.in

Even if you haven't read any other article in this issue, you could not have missed the cover. Artificial Intelligence is not something that needs to be explained all over again, even to a layman. If you have been observing the buzzwords of the last few years, you'll have no problem in recognising words such as big data, machine learning etc. You would know by now where we were headed. Where AI is not just a reality, but an attractive career choice as well.

Every industry has a need for AI. In such a new but hot job area, it is no shocker that the demand is high but supply is low. On the other hand, there are ample ways to gain the right skills and make a career in this right now. But before you do that, you have to understand what a career in artificial intelligence really involves.

The disciplines

You cannot ask someone 'to go and learn artificial intelligence' or 'do you know artificial intelligence?'. The

phrase, by itself, mostly invokes the outcome of its applications, rather than the intricacies of its development. So, you're more likely to think of the Terminator rather than machine learning when asking yourself 'what is artificial intelligence?'. This umbrella term also encompasses the field of data science.

Machine learning, as the name implies, enables the 'learning' part in artificial intelligence. This is different from just getting insights from data (which is in the domain of data science). Machine learning enables a program to change based on the data it encounters, without the requirement of explicitly programming every possibility. For example, the News Feed on Facebook uses machine learning to personalise your feed. If you frequently stop scrolling in order to read or "like" a particular friend's posts, the News Feed will start to show more of that friend's activity in your feed. Behind the scenes, the software is simply using statistical analysis and predictive analytics to identify patterns in your data and use the patterns to populate the News Feed. Should you have a fight and no longer want to read, like or comment on the

friend's posts, that new data will be included in the data set and the News Feed will adjust accordingly to incorporate your enmity.

The other technical component is data science – this is where you actually deal with the data to get results that enable machine learning. To achieve the level of intelligence, you need a practical AI implementation, vast dataset processing to cover every possible event and establish a predictable behavior in your AI.

A-I-Q

While machine learning and data science are broad fields that constitute AI, they also consist of the actual skills that you will need to master in order to work in AI. One of the first things that you'll need is a background in engineering, to be more precise – software engineering. While the exact language may not matter, a fundamental understanding of programming and how to work with code will go a long way in getting a job in AI. Pro tip – try to go for open source projects and keep your code available for potential interviewers to see. Look out for the